

Mosaic Multicultural Connections Volunteer Handbook

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Website: mosaicmc.org.au

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Welcome to Mosaic Multicultural Connections

Welcome and thank you for deciding to become a volunteer of the Mosaic Multicultural Connections (Mosaic). This handbook provides a general guide to volunteering at Mosaic.

We appreciate and value the skills and experience volunteers contribute to the operation of our projects, services and facilities. Mosaic relies on the generous community support of our extensive volunteer team to support our programs.

Mosaic is committed to providing best practice standards for volunteer programs and promote a collaborative, supportive and safe working environment for volunteers. We aspire to making the experience an enjoyable and enriching one for all of our volunteers.

About Us

Mosaic is an independent, community based, not-for-profit entity delivering settlement, family, and aged care services to a comprehensive client base.

Mosaic was initially established in Newcastle in 1981 as the "Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle & Hunter Region Ltd" by the Federal Government to assist migrants & refugees in their settlement into Australian life. Since that time, we have broadened our services and area of operation. Our services include the social inclusion of the aged, the isolated and the resettled newcomers to our region. In 2006 we changed our registered business name to "Northern Settlement Services Ltd" to reflect better alignment with government programs.

As of September 2022, "Mosaic Multicultural Connections" became our new trading name. Over the past 40+ years, we have assisted people from migrant and refugee backgrounds and their communities across Newcastle, the Hunter, Lake Macquarie, and also through Mosaic offices covering the Central Coast and New England (Armidale and Tamworth).

On 12th November 2024, Mosaic's headquarters was relocated from our long-term home at 8 Chaucer St, Hamilton, to new premises at Level 3, 3 Hopetoun St, Charlestown, beginning a brand new chapter in our organisation's journey.

Our Mission

"To support and inspire culturally diverse people and communities to overcome barriers and thrive."

Our Vision

"A connected community where diversity defines and nourishes us."



Our Values

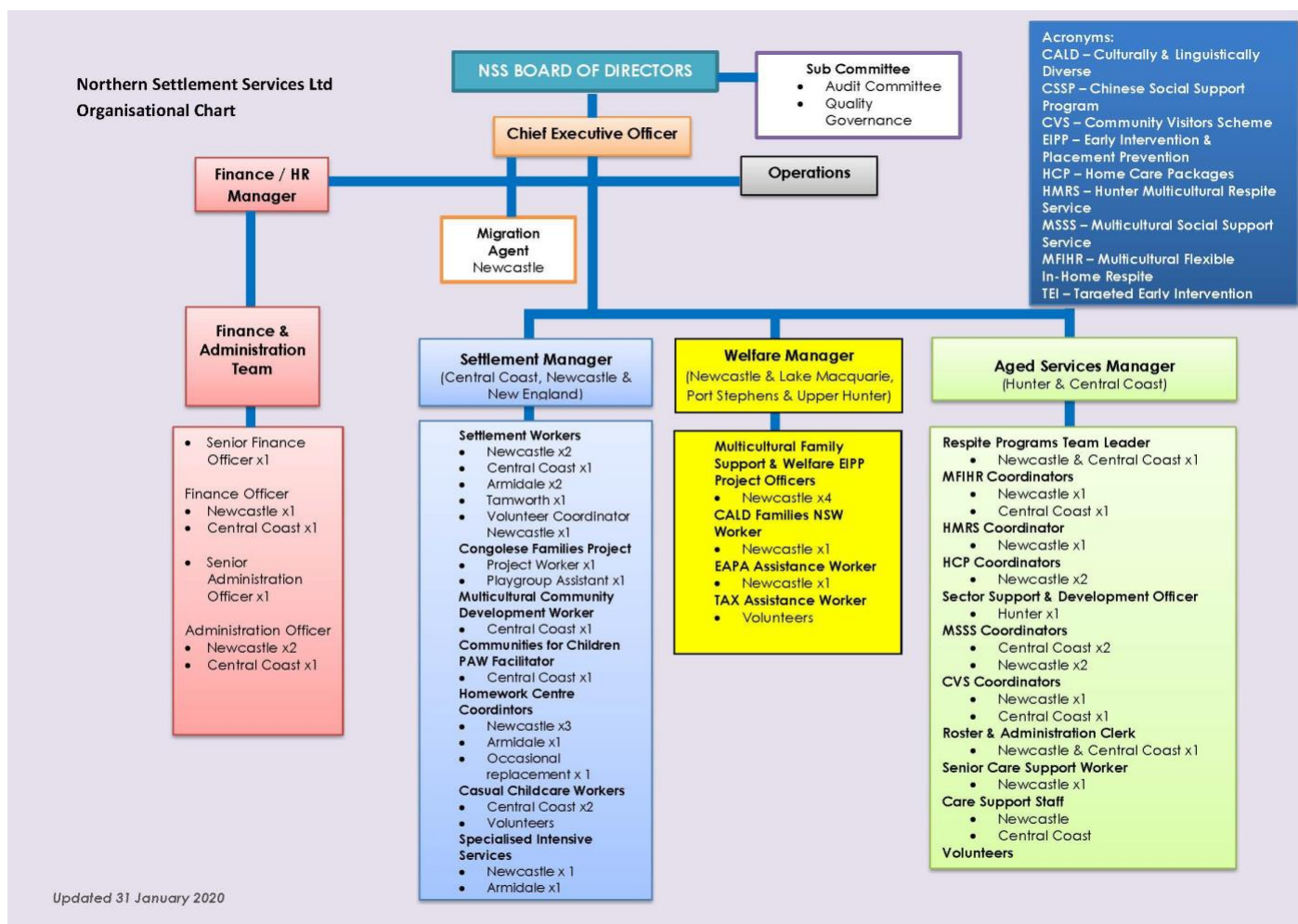
TRUST
TRANSPARENCY
RESPECT
COLLABORATION
CREATION

Services Provided by Mosaic

Our services include:

Settlement Services	• Casework and information • Community development • Youth work • Support for new ethno-specific communities • Employment support • Volunteering support
Aged Care	• Home care support • Respite support • Community visitors • Social support • Sector support and development • Volunteering support
Family Support	• Casework and information • Early intervention services • Welfare Support • Community development
Immigration Services	• Migration advice, information and assistance
Disability Services	• Client co-ordination of supports

Mosaic Organisational Chart



Types of Volunteer Roles

Our volunteering programs are diverse and offer a range of fulfilling opportunities including:

- Assisting adults with English language skills and course work
- Social visits to aged care facilities or private homes to prevent or respond to feelings of isolation
- Assisting social support groups
- Tutoring through citizenship booklet and test training
- Helping clients with general day to day or urgent need, e.g. shopping, attending appointments
- Supervising a learner driver using the client's own car
- Assisting at events, e.g. Harmony Day, Refugee Week



- Tutoring students in one of our weekly after school Homework Centres
- Assisting with children playgroups

Please note that not all volunteer programs are available in all locations.

Benefits of Volunteering

Amongst the many benefits of volunteering, it provides the opportunity to:

- Help the community
- Create social and professional networks
- Gain work experience and learn valuable new skills
- Build confidence
- Enjoy contact with a diverse range of people
- Enhance existing skills and challenge yourself
- Have fun!

Volunteer Policies and Procedures

Mosaic has key policies that cover volunteer-specific matters such as rights and responsibilities of volunteers. Mosaic also has general policies that relate to volunteers such as grievance and incident reporting policies and procedures. These policies are continually updated and are located in the Mosaic Policies and Procedures Manual.

Volunteer Guiding Principles

Mosaic is directed by the following principles:

- Mosaic is committed to Volunteer Australia's National Standards for volunteer involvement
- Volunteering benefits the community and the volunteer
- Volunteer work is unpaid
- Volunteering is always a matter of choice
- Volunteering is not compulsorily undertaken to receive pensions or government allowances
- Volunteering is a legitimate way in which citizens can participate in the activities of their community
- Volunteering is a vehicle for individuals or groups to address human, environmental and social needs
- Volunteering is an activity performed in the not for profit sector only
- Volunteers should not work in excess of 16 hours per week
- Volunteering is not a substitute for paid work
- Volunteers do not replace paid workers nor constitute a threat to the job security of paid workers



- Volunteering at Mosaic is for people over 18 years of age
 - Volunteering respects the rights, dignity and culture of others
 - Volunteering promotes human rights and equality
- (Adapted from *Principles of Volunteering: Why Have Them? Volunteering Australia*)**

Volunteer Rights and Responsibilities

Volunteers have the right to:

- To work in a healthy and safe environment (Work Health and Safety Act 2011 and Work Health and Safety Regulation 2011)
- To work in an environment free of bullying, harassment and discrimination
- To be interviewed and employed in accordance with anti-discrimination legislation
- To be adequately covered by insurance
- To be given accurate and truthful information about Mosaic
- To be reimbursed for out-of-pocket expenses incurred on behalf of Mosaic depending on funding specifications
- To be advised of the Mosaic's volunteer policy and any other policies that affect their work
- Not to do the work of paid staff during industrial disputes
- To have a job description and agreed working hours
- To take a break
- To have access to a grievance procedure
- To be provided with an orientation or induction session
- To have their confidential and personal information dealt with in accordance with the principles of the *Privacy Act 1988*
- To be provided with sufficient training for them to do their jobs

Volunteer responsibilities:

Mosaic volunteers are expected to take responsibility for their volunteer role. Volunteers have the responsibility to

- To understand the rules and guidelines of Mosaic and be prepared to comply with them
- Be conscientious
- Be punctual
- Be reliable
- Work within their volunteer role
- Be willing to train and take part in ongoing training when needed



- Give notice if their availability changes or are leaving Mosaic
- Maintain privacy and confidentiality
- Support other volunteers and be able to work productively as a team member
- Seek support when needed
- Adhere to Mosaic policies and procedures
- Report any injuries or hazards
- Address areas of conflict with the volunteer coordinator /supervisor
- Recognise personal limitations and avoid over-extending themselves

Mosaic Rights and Responsibilities

Mosaic has the right to:

- Make decisions regarding volunteer placement
- Expect volunteers to adhere to their position descriptions, agreement and relevant policy and procedures
- Expect volunteers to abide by the Code of Conduct.
- Expect volunteers to respect Mosaic clients, staff and services
- Expect commitment to Mosaic
- Expect volunteers to undertake training provided for them as required
- Evaluate volunteer performance according to Mosaic policies and procedures
- Release volunteers under certain circumstances

Mosaic has the responsibility to:

- Provide an induction and required training
- Engage volunteers in relevant decision making processes
- Respect your privacy, including keeping your private information confidential
- Create clear lines of communication about grievance procedures
- Provide a supportive and safe work environment
- Communicate emergency procedures

Clearances

Every Mosaic volunteer is required to have a police check (Mosaic will provide the form) and Working with Children Check (potential volunteers are required to apply online and/or provide their WWC check number or application number). A volunteer cannot commence in their role until these clearances have been completed.



Work Health and Safety

Mosaic is dedicated to providing a safe and healthy environment for all staff and volunteers. As an Mosaic volunteer we ask that you adhere to Mosaic WHS requirements. This includes:

- Co-operating and taking reasonable care for the health and safety of yourself and of others affected by your actions during your volunteering
- Co-operating with instructions, supporting and promoting work health and safety
- Having the responsibility to actively participate in the program
- Having the responsibility to comply with relevant Mosaic WHS management system policies, procedures and programs as appropriate
- Not bypassing or misusing systems or equipment provided for WHS purposes.
- Reporting potential and actual hazards to your volunteer coordinator/supervisor that come to your attention.
- Acting and encouraging others to act in a healthy and safe manner
- Reporting and rectifying any unsafe conditions or acts that come to your attention
- Making yourself familiar with relevant emergency procedures and evacuation plan

Privacy and Confidentiality

While working as a volunteer of Mosaic you may have access to private and confidential information about Mosaic and Mosaic clients. You are expected to keep this information completely confidential. There is a Mosaic privacy policy that will be provided to you on request.

Each volunteer will be required to sign a 'Volunteer Agreement' as part of their volunteer registration. Breach of this agreement may result in dismissal.

Reporting

For reporting purposes all volunteer hours are required to be recorded. Your volunteer coordinator/supervisor will inform you of the relevant process of collecting information on volunteer hours.

Incident and hazard reporting

Any incident or hazard that has been identified during the course of or on the way to or from your volunteering activity must be reported to your volunteer coordinator/supervisor.

Mandatory reporting



It is a legal obligation of our organisation to report suspected or actual abuse and threats to harm self or others, including children, elderly, suicide and domestic violence.

It is your duty of care to report any suspected or actual abuse to your volunteer coordinator/supervisor immediately. Do not take any action except to identify and report these instances.

Interpreters

Volunteers are not expected and should not act as interpreters or translators in relation to client assessments, in a legal or financial setting, migration interviews or at any health/medical related appointments.

Mosaic utilises the skills of Accredited Translators and Interpreters. Other organisations provide interpreting and translating, for example General Practitioners and medical facilities/hospitals. Utilise these provisions when necessary. If you require an interpreter or translator speak with your volunteer coordinator/supervisor.

Ceasing volunteering

Should you wish to exit from your role, we ask that you give your volunteer coordinator/supervisor adequate notice, to minimise the impact on clients.

You will be invited to provide feedback on your volunteer experience by way of an exit survey. Gathering this type of information is important as it helps to further develop and improve our volunteer programs.

Grievance Procedures

If there are any grievances arising out of working conditions, complaints, unfair treatment, difficulties with Mosaic staff, other volunteers or clients please discuss the issue with your volunteer coordinator/supervisor or their team manager. Complaints or grievances from volunteers will be managed transparently, consistently and equitably. Mosaic has a formal policy on Grievance Procedures that applies to staff and volunteers.



Insurance

Mosaic holds and maintains Public Liability and Personal Accident Insurance cover for people engaged as volunteers. Volunteers are not entitled to Workers Compensation under the *Workers Compensation Act 1987 (NSW)*.

All volunteers are recommended to have Comprehensive Insurance cover for their own vehicle during the course of their volunteer work with Mosaic. It is also advisable for you to contact your policy provider and inform them of an estimated frequency of the trips you would make as a volunteer. This is only a precaution in case of a future claim.

Information on insurance coverage can be provided to you on request.

Reimbursement

Some of the volunteer programs are funded to provide reimbursements for out-of-pocket pre-approved expenses, such as phone calls and travel expenses.

You will be informed if you are entitled to reimbursements and what documentation is required by your volunteer coordinator/supervisor.

Receiving Gifts

It is Mosaic policy not to accept money or expensive gifts from clients of the service.

It is a kind gesture and often customary in other cultures to show appreciation and thanks by giving a gift. You may accept a small gift such as: chocolates, flowers, cards etc.

If a client or someone from their family offers you money or an expensive gift, report this to your volunteer coordinator/supervisor. Your volunteer coordinator/supervisor will document the matter so that there are no repercussions or misunderstandings from the client, other family members, other service providers etc.

Remember that gift giving is an enjoyable as receiving a gift, so be mindful not to offend the giver. If you are unsure, speak to your volunteer coordinator/supervisor.